

educational environment, the INDIA TODAY Best Colleges rankings reflect where Indian higher education stands today. Our rankings are the established benchmark for quality education and it also lets us know what is required. The purpose of these rankings is never to merely keep score but to reveal where there is real change and development. Now in its 14th year, the INDIA TODAY Best Colleges rankings are now virtually an institution in themselves, both as a comprehensive database for undergraduate education in the country and as a trend-spotter.

The news this year is that no one is daunted by the arrival of foreign educational institutions. P.C. Jain, principal, Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC) has predicted that foreign colleges would impact India in three ways, a surrender from some, a collaboration by others and, he says, "some colleges who will accept the challenge and will not only survive but also excel in future."

Professor Nalinaksh S. Vyas, head, department of mechanical engineering and nuclear engineering and technology programme, IIT-Kanpur (IIT-K), has a different idea: "We don't fear foreign institutions. Before they are allowed in India, IIT-K would have set its feet in other countries." Meenakshi Gopinath, principal of Lady Shri Ram College, says India must build, "its own idiom of undergraduate education and not ape the West". Sanjay G. Dhanda, director, IIT-K, also believes India needs an undergraduate 'model' of education. He has codenamed it the 'Nalanda' model—after the ancient university—which should be followed across the country.

There remains amongst leaders in our education a desire to make undergraduate learning more flexible with a greater research component in some streams to help students in the workforce. The reason St. Xavier's College, Kolkata, took the No.1 spot in the commerce stream this year after SRCC's 12-year hold had much to do with its philosophy of constantly upgrading its curriculum to make its courses professional. As St. Xavier's principal

## 13 YEAR TOPPERS

### ARTS

| YEARS | 1ST PLACE                    | 2ND PLACE                     | 3RD PLACE                         |
|-------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 2010  | LSR, Delhi                   | Loyola College, Chennai       | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      |
| 2009  | Loyola College, Chennai      | LSR, Delhi                    | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      |
| 2008  | Loyola College, Chennai      | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      |
| 2007  | Loyola College, Chennai      | St. Stephen's College, Delhi  | LSR, Delhi                        |
| 2006  | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai | Presidency College, Kolkata   | Loyola College, Chennai           |
| 2005  | LSR, Delhi                   | Presidency College, Chennai   | Loyola College, Chennai           |
| 2004  | Loyola College, Chennai      | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai      |
| 2003  | Loyola College, Chennai      | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  | LSR, Delhi                        |
| 2002  | Presidency College, Chennai  | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata | Madras Christian College, Chennai |
| 2001  | Presidency College, Kolkata  | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata | LSR, Delhi                        |
| 2000  | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai | Loyola College, Chennai       | Presidency College, Chennai       |
| 1999  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi | Presidency College, Kolkata   | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai      |
| 1998  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi | Presidency College, Kolkata   | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata     |

### COMMERCE

| YEARS | 1ST PLACE                           | 2ND PLACE                           | 3RD PLACE                     |
|-------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 2010  | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata       | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | Loyola College, Chennai       |
| 2009  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata       | Loyola College, Chennai       |
| 2008  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | Loyola College, Chennai             | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata |
| 2007  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | LSR, Delhi                          | Loyola College, Chennai       |
| 2006  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai        | Loyola College, Chennai       |
| 2005  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai        | BM College of Commerce, Pune  |
| 2004  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | Presidency College, Chennai         | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata |
| 2003  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai        | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata |
| 2002  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata       | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  |
| 2001  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata       | Presidency College, Chennai   |
| 2000  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai        | Presidency College, Chennai   |
| 1999  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata       | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  |
| 1998  | Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi | Loyola College, Chennai             | St. Joseph's (Com), Bangalore |

### SCIENCE

| YEARS | 1ST PLACE                         | 2ND PLACE                     | 3RD PLACE                       |
|-------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 2010  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      | Loyola College, Chennai       | Presidency College, Kolkata     |
| 2009  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Stephen's College, Delhi  | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata   |
| 2008  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Stephen's College, Delhi  | Presidency College, Kolkata     |
| 2007  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata | St. Xavier's College, Ahmedabad |
| 2006  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  | Presidency College, Chennai     |
| 2005  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Stephen's College, Delhi  | Presidency College, Kolkata     |
| 2004  | Presidency College, Chennai       | St. Xavier's College, Kolkata | Loyola College, Chennai         |
| 2003  | Madras Christian College, Chennai | Presidency College, Kolkata   | Presidency College, Chennai     |
| 2002  | Loyola College, Chennai           | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai  | Presidency College, Kolkata     |
| 2001  | Presidency College, Chennai       | Loyola College, Chennai       | St. Stephen's College, Delhi    |
| 2000  | Presidency College, Chennai       | St. Stephen's College, Delhi  | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai    |
| 1999  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      | Presidency College, Kolkata   | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai    |
| 1998  | St. Stephen's College, Delhi      | Presidency College, Kolkata   | St. Xavier's College, Mumbai    |